

of his mortgage while paying only a couple hundred dollars a month to continue living in this property. He could ride out a down cycle with little difficulty.

The person on the standard path would have to continue paying \$1,550 each month, even if they lost their job and couldn't afford that payment. They would have a difficult time selling the house if needed because they would be under water. We saw this time and again in the financial crisis of 2008 and 2009. Yet people continue to take the standard path through life and take this risk every day.

Jonathan

If I could go back and change a single financial choice that I made in the past, it would be with regards to real estate. In particular, I wish I'd pursued house hacking.

College, or your early twenties, seems like the perfect opportunity to deploy this technique. You are used to sharing space anyways. Why not use it as an opportunity to accelerate your path to FI and get some landlord experience in the process. Both Scott Trench and Chad Carson benefited from this strategy. It's pretty evident that individuals who figure this